

Here comes the world's first Linux-based surgical robot

Researchers at the University of Washington, Seattle, are on their way to releasing a number of medical robots called Ravens with wing-like arms.

The Ravens, developed by Blake Hannaford and his colleagues, were developed initially for the American army as a prototype for robotic surgery on the battlefield. The Ravens are reportedly light, compact and cost around \$250,000.

What's unique about the Raven is that it is the first surgical robot to use open source software. Researchers have the option of experimenting too, as the Linux-based operating system of the robot allows anyone to modify and improve the original code. With the help of Ravens, surgeons can make tiny incisions that cause less tissue damage enabling the patient to recover faster. American regulators have not yet approved the Ravens and as of now, experiments with these robots are just restricted to animals and human cadavers.

The first Ravens were delivered in February 2012 across universities in America.

Foursquare switches to OpenStreetMap

Foursquare, which previously used Google's Maps API for mapping, is now using open map data from the OpenStreetMap (OSM) project for its location-based social networking service. "During our January hackathon, one of our intrepid engineers wondered what the world would look like if we made our own maps. To do that, he used data from OpenStreetMap. (It's a crowd-sourced global atlas, and it's kind of amazing! It's like Wikipedia for geography.) We love the idea of open data, and were happy to try it out," a source in the company said. The New York-based start-up, with a community of more than 15 million users worldwide, said it is using MapBox Streets' global block-level map to power all of its maps.



Firefox users can now find out who is spying on them

Mozilla has unveiled a new feature in its Firefox browser which will let users know who is spying on them on the Internet. This is a new add-on which enables users to instantly view which companies are watching them as they browse.

Ironically, the move comes almost at the same time when Google introduced its 'controversial' privacy policy. The privacy policy aims to provide data for Google's advertising business, despite the fact that tracking of private data may be illegal in many countries.

According to an ET report, Gary Kovacs, chief executive officer, Mozilla, said that this new Collusion add-on in Firefox will enable the users to 'pull back the curtain' on web advertising firms and other third parties that track people's online movements.



Free accounts for open source developers: PageKite

With an aim to thank the free software community, PageKite is providing open source developers with free of charge access to their reverse-proxy

SUSE Linux Enterprise 11 Service Pack 2 released

SUSE has announced the general availability of SUSE Linux Enterprise 11 Service Pack 2 (SP2). This latest update to the industry's most interoperable platform for mission-critical computing offers improved performance, reliability and efficiency, while maintaining enterprise quality and application compatibility. Customers can use SUSE Linux Enterprise 11 SP2 to deliver



mission-critical IT services faster, more reliably, and more cost effectively, now and in the future. SUSE Linux Enterprise 11 SP2 is the first release built using SUSE's new, forward-looking development model. Notable features include an updated Linux kernel, enhanced filesystem support, and expanded virtualisation capabilities.

US government to use Android phones for top secret calls

The National Security Agency (NSA) has developed a super-secure Android phone built from an off-the-shelf kit, which will be used by the US government employees to discuss top secret matters.

NSA developed about 100 of these Fishbowl phones and gave them to US government staff. All these devices are designed in accordance with NSA's security rules. The price and usability factors were also kept in mind while designing the Android phones. NSA's 40-year old Information Assurance Directorate designed and built these phones to serve as means for secure communications between employees of the US government. The government employees testing these devices include those from the Department of Defence as well.